

Mona Lott

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Your other secret

You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Paige knows you were the leak.
3. Get Sue to acknowledge that the legal risk is real.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened our confidential restitution negotiations. I was trying to get disputed objects returned without a public collapse of the talks. He preferred owning the objects to answering the letters.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Registrar's fax desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with a confidential restitution packet. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Registrar's fax desk. I was dealing with a confidential restitution packet. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Registrar's fax desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes a confidential restitution packet. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Registrar's fax desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.